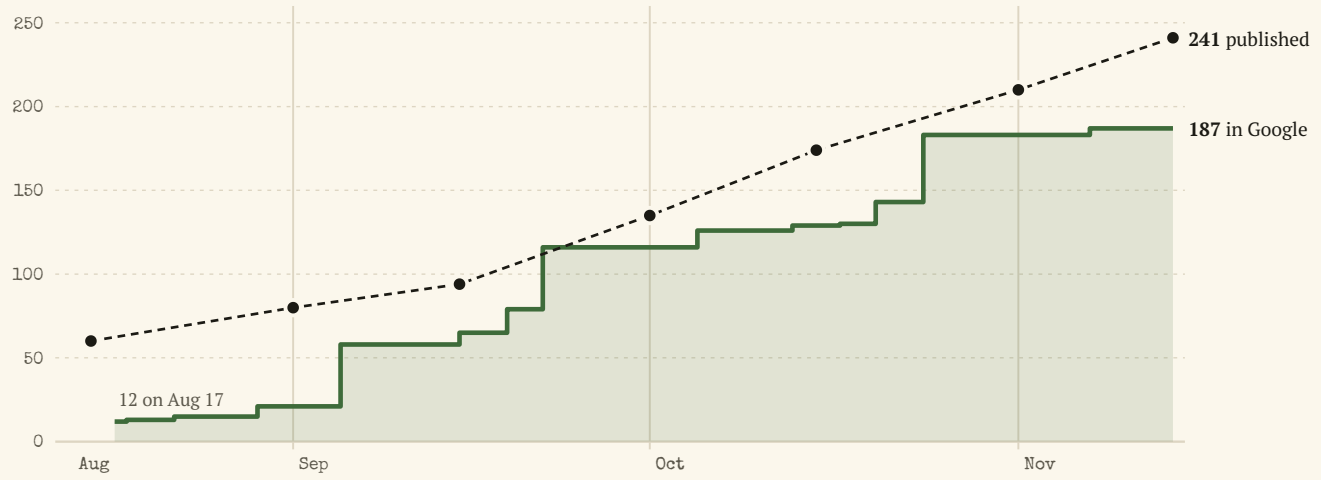
How Google Found Us

Google Search Console
and the check log
Data through Nov 11, 2026

In three months Google went from knowing **12** of the Ear's pages to **187**. Weekly search appearances grew about tenfold, and on Nov 9 the Ear reached 50 clicks in 28 days, which earned Google's badge.

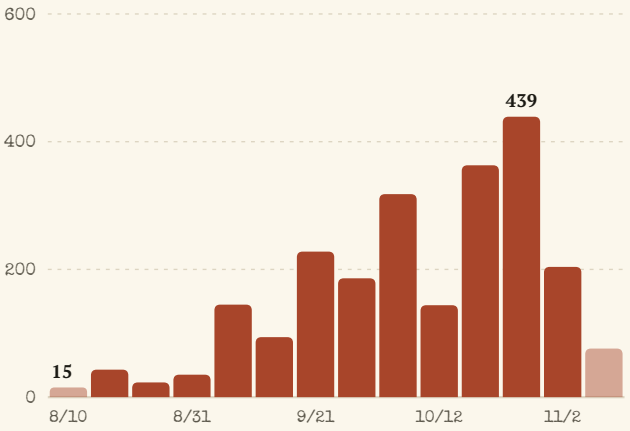
Pages in Google, against pages published

Solid green: pages Google has indexed. Dashed with dots: pages in the Ear's sitemap, from each check.



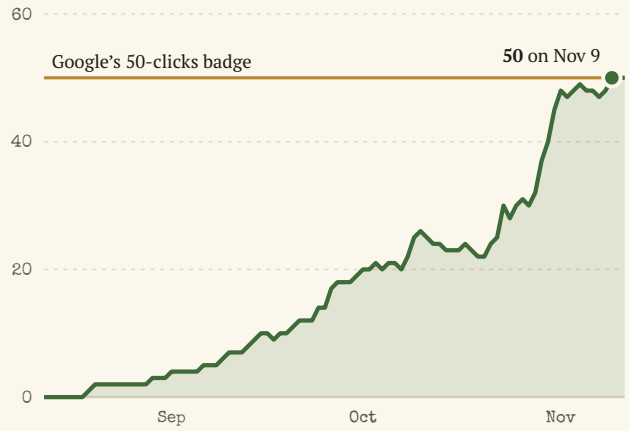
Search appearances a week

Times an Ear page showed up in Google results. The faded last bar is a partial week.



Clicks from Google, previous 28 days

Rolling total. It reached 50 on Nov 9, the week Google sent the badge.



Why 43 pages are left out on purpose

Each episode's lead story also has its own page, with the same text as the episode page. Those pages tell Google to credit the episode page instead, so Google indexes one copy, not two. Google lists them as "alternate page with proper canonical". That is the correct result, not a problem.

What would move these numbers

46 pages are found but not yet crawled, mostly July stories. Google gets to them with time and inbound links. Most searches that find the Ear are for events: Scruffy Roots Festival (21 appearances in 28 days), Spooky Streets (12), Borderland Playhouse (15). Timely event stories are what pull new readers in.

THE SOUTH KNOXVILLE EAR · HOW THE SITE STAYS FINDABLE

SEO Health Check

Runs 1st & 15th, 9:00 AM
on the Mac mini, by Claude
Status as of Sat, Nov 14, 2026

Twice a month Claude checks that Google can find, read and credit every page on soknoear.com. It fixes what it can, logs the numbers, and **alerts you the moment anything is broken or can't be reached.** It stays silent only when everything works.

SITE	IN GOOGLE	CLICKS, 28 DAYS	WAITING ON GOOGLE
241 / 241	**187**	**50**	**46**
pages in the sitemap, all live, all indexable, all pointing at the right canonical	pages indexed. 106 not, and 43 of those are left out on purpose	from 1,170 search appearances, avg. position 6.8. 84 in 90 days, so it's climbing	pages found but not crawled yet, mostly July stories. Was 64 of 80 on Sep 1

1 Checks the site itself

- ✓ Sitemap serves and grows with each episode. Every URL in it returns 200
- ✓ robots.txt only hides `/next`, `/draft/`, `/desk/`
- ✓ Canonicals: the newest episode credits the homepage. Older episodes and stories credit themselves. Feature stories credit their episode
- ✓ Every story carries NewsArticle data, so Google reads it as news
- ✓ Nothing public is accidentally hidden. www and http forward to soknoear.com

2 Reads Google Search Console

- ✓ Opens the property as the **note15** Google account. The sparkpoint account has no access
- ✓ Page indexing: how many pages are in, why the rest aren't, any new reason
- ✓ Performance: clicks, appearances, top searches and pages

Alternate page with proper canonical (feature stories)	43
Discovered, not yet crawled (Google's queue)	46
Crawled, not indexed (font files, plus 1 July story)	12
Page with redirect (www / http)	4
Blocked by robots (old /stats, from Sep 19, clearing)	1

Top searches: scruffy roots festival, spooky streets knoxville, borderland playhouse. Top pages: the homepage (20 clicks), Pink Is Punk Halloweemo (5), Scruffy Roots Fest (3), Bow Wow Bingo (3).

3 Fixes what it can, then records it

- ✓ Redirects, robots rules, stale config, missing links are fixed, verified and reported as done. You don't get a to-do list
- ✓ Logs every run in `docs/seo-log.md`. Anything still open goes in `docs/OPEN-ITEMS.md` with the date it opened

! When it alerts you

- ✓ Anything on the site is broken
- ✓ Anything it should read **can't be reached**: Search Console, the server, the site, a signed-out browser
- ✓ Something needs your decision or your login
- ✓ **Every run** until it's fixed. Email plus a phone push, one line: what's wrong, how old, the one fix

When everything works it sends nothing, so an alert always means something.

What went wrong

- ✗ Search Console went unread for **91 days** (Aug 15 to Nov 14). It was opened with the wrong Google account
- ✗ Each run logged it as "not blocking", so it never alerted you
- ✗ The alert command didn't load the server's keys, so even a real alert would have sent nothing
- ✓ Fixed today: note15 account, the alert rule above, and the email channel. A test alert landed

Needs you, once

Text alerts are off. The server has no AgentPhone key and no phone number to text. Send me both and alerts also come as texts. Until then: email, plus a phone push when Remote Control is on.